

ALX Separates The "Programme Calendar" From The "Learning Structure"

ALX programmes can be:

- **Self-paced/rolling**, where there may be no fixed cohort start date.
- **Structured programmes**, where learners move through defined weeks and milestones.
- **Hybrid experiences**, combining self-directed learning with live learning, peer learning and projects.

For example, current ALX Data Analytics is listed as **7 weeks at 20 hours/week**, while Data Science is **22 weeks at 20 hours/week** and is self-paced. ([ALX Africa](#))

So ALX doesn't necessarily say:

"Every programme starts September 21 and ends December 20."

Instead, the programme itself has a learning architecture.

The Most Important Thing ALX Does: Build A WEEKLY OPERATING RHYTHM

This is probably the biggest lesson for AAN.

Look at ALX's Data Analytics programme structure.

Its published programme material specifies:

Weekly

- Assessment submission on Tuesday
- Learning webinar on Thursday

Monthly

- ALX Foundations milestone
- Self-placement reporting

Then the curriculum is broken into learning blocks:

- Weeks 1–2: Explore 101
- Weeks 3–5: Preparing Data
- Weeks 6–9: Querying Data
- Weeks 10–14: Visualising Data. ([ALX Africa](#))

That's much more sophisticated than simply saying:

Monday = class
Tuesday = class
Wednesday = class.

ALX defines **what happens every week**, **what must be submitted**, **when learners receive support**, and **what milestone they are working toward**.

3. They Combine Three Different Calendars

I would describe ALX's model as having three layers.

Layer 1 — Programme Calendar

This answers:

When does the programme happen?

Examples:

- Start
- Orientation
- Programme events
- Webinars
- Assessment deadlines
- Milestones
- Graduation/completion activities

ALX provides programme calendars that learners can add to their personal calendars so they receive notifications for events and deadlines. ([ALX Africa](#))

Layer 2 — Learning Calendar

This answers:

What should I be learning this week?

For example:

Week 1–2

Explore 101

Week 3–5

Preparing Data

Week 6–9

Querying Data

Week 10–14

Visualising Data. ([ALX Africa](#))

Layer 3 — Activity/Delivery Calendar

This answers:

How am I expected to learn it?

ALX's model can combine:

- self-paced learning
- live sessions
- peer learning
- projects
- quizzes
- assessments
- community interaction
- career preparation.

For one current AiCE format, ALX describes the learning mix as approximately **15% live learning, 10% peer learning, 70% projects and 5% quizzes**. ([ALX Africa](#))

That is a major lesson for AAN.

4. ALX Does NOT Make Live Teaching The Entire Programme

This is where I think our previous AAN timetable was too close to a traditional school timetable.

AAN's previous model looked like:

Monday — class
Tuesday — class
Wednesday — class
Thursday — class
Friday — class
Saturday — labs

That risks making AAN look like an online university timetable.

ALX's philosophy is closer to:

Learn → Practice → Collaborate → Build → Submit → Get Feedback → Improve

The learner spends substantial time **outside the live classroom**.

ALX's software-related programmes have historically described the model as approximately **15% live learning, 10% peer learning, 70% project work and 5% quizzes**. ([ALX Africa](#))

That is extremely relevant to AAN.

5. Their LMS Is Part Of The Timetable

Another important difference:

The timetable doesn't exist independently from the LMS.

ALX's Savanna LMS organizes the learner's materials, quizzes and projects, and learners can move between weeks to access the current week's content. ([ALX Africa](#))

So the real timetable is:

Calendar + LMS + Community + Assessments + Projects.

Not simply a PDF.

This means AAN's timetable should eventually be connected directly to:

AAN LMS

- Week opens
 - Module released
 - Learning materials
 - Live session
 - Practice
 - Assignment
 - Mentor check
 - Assessment
 - Feedback
 - Next week.
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6. ALX Uses "Milestones", Not Just Attendance

This is another major lesson.

For example, ALX's Pathway Foundations requires learners to complete assessments, milestones, module checks and tests and meet specified performance requirements. ([Alx Africa](#))

So the question isn't simply:

"Did you attend the class?"

It's:

"Did you achieve the learning milestone?"

That is exactly how I think AAN should operate.

7. Their Calendar Accommodates Flexibility

ALX also understands that many African learners are:

- working
- studying

- running businesses
- freelancing
- caring for families.

For example, AiCE's current self-paced model has **no strict weekly deadlines**, allows learners to pause/resume, and is designed around approximately 20 hours per short course. ([ALX Africa](#))

Yet ALX still maintains a programme calendar for events and important updates. ([ALX Africa](#))

So there is a very useful distinction:

FLEXIBILITY ≠ ABSENCE OF STRUCTURE

AAN should adopt this.

8. Community Is Actually Part Of The Academic System

ALX doesn't treat community as merely a WhatsApp group.

Learners have programme-specific community spaces, events, peer interaction and access to mentors/support. ([ALX Africa](#))

Their programme materials also emphasize peer learning and collaboration.

This means the academic experience becomes:

LMS + Live Learning + Peer Community + Projects + Career Support.

That's very close to the **Digital Campus** model we discussed for AAN.

9. What ALX's Structure Teaches Us About AAN

I would therefore change our AAN model from:

OLD APPROACH

Fixed class timetable

Monday → Generative AI

Tuesday → Automation

Wednesday → Data Science

Thursday → Frontend

Friday → AI Engineering

Saturday → Labs

into:

AAN ACADEMY PROGRAMME OPERATING MODEL

1. ANNUAL ACADEMIC CALENDAR

Defines:

- Academic year
- Cohort start
- Cohort windows
- Academic breaks
- Major continental events
- Graduation periods
- Application/enrollment periods.

2. PROGRAMME CALENDAR

Each programme gets:

- Programme duration
- Start date
- End date
- Weekly learning objectives
- Assessment schedule
- Project milestones
- Live sessions
- Career activities
- Capstone
- Graduation requirements.

3. WEEKLY LEARNING RHYTHM

For example:

MONDAY — LEARN

New module released + instructional content.

TUESDAY — PRACTICE

Individual exercises and guided practice.

WEDNESDAY — CONNECT

Live class / mentor / welfare check.

THURSDAY — APPLY

Students apply the concept to a practical problem.

FRIDAY — BUILD

Project / peer collaboration / feedback.

SATURDAY — SUPPORT

Lab, technical clinic, career session or masterclass.

SUNDAY — REST

Absolutely nothing compulsory.

This is much closer to the learning philosophy evidenced in ALX's programme materials.

10. The Biggest Lesson: AAN Should NOT Create One Giant Timetable For All Programmes

This is the biggest change I would make to the timetable we just produced.

We can still have a **Master Academy Calendar**, but underneath it we need **seven programme calendars**.

For example:

AI AUTOMATION

Week 1: AI + Automation Foundations

Week 2: Workflow Design

Week 3: No-Code Automation

Week 4: AI Integrations

Week 5: APIs

Week 6: AI Agents

Week 7: Business Automation

Week 8: Advanced Workflows

Week 9: Testing

Week 10: Deployment

Week 11: Portfolio Project

Week 12: Capstone + Demo

Then its weekly activity structure could be:

Day	Activity
Monday	Module/Learning
Tuesday	Live Instruction
Wednesday	Practice + Mentor
Thursday	Build
Friday	Peer Review
Saturday	Lab/Clinic
Sunday	FREE

Another programme might have a completely different structure.

11. What I Think AAN Should Copy From ALX — And What We Shouldn't

COPY

1. Programme-based structure

Not just an institutional timetable.

2. Weekly learning milestones

Every week must have a clear outcome.

3. Projects

Learning should result in something tangible.

4. Peer learning

Students shouldn't depend entirely on instructors.

5. Career readiness

Career development should be integrated, not added at graduation.

6. Community

The community should support learning.

7. Calendar integration

Students should be able to add programme events to their personal calendars.

8. Flexible learning

Especially because AAN serves learners across Africa.

9. LMS-driven learning

The LMS should be the academic source of truth.

10. Measurable progression

AAN should know exactly who is progressing, struggling or inactive.

But DON'T Copy ALX Blindly

AAN has an opportunity to do something even more focused.

ALX is a very broad technology and career ecosystem.

AAN should own a sharper position:

Africa's AI Workforce Academy.

Our academic system should therefore revolve around:

**AI Literacy → AI Productivity → AI Automation → AI Engineering → Projects → Portfolio
→ Career/Business → Opportunity**

And eventually:

**Student → AI Practitioner → AI Professional → AI Worker/Entrepreneur → Mentor →
Ambassador**

My RRecommmendation For AAN Now

After looking at how ALX structures its programmes, **I would revise the timetable we just created again.**

Not because the previous timetable is wrong, but because we should move from a **"school timetable"** to an **"Academy Programme Operating System."**

The final AAN structure should have **four documents**, not one:

DOCUMENT 1

AAN Continental Academic Calendar

The master annual calendar for the whole institution.

DOCUMENT 2

AAN Academy Master Weekly Operating Schedule

What happens institution-wide every Monday–Saturday.

DOCUMENT 3

Individual Programme Academic Calendars

Seven separate calendars:

- Generative AI

- AI Automation
- AI Automation for Content Creators
- Applied Data Science
- Frontend Development
- Backend Development — Laravel
- AI Engineering

DOCUMENT 4

AAN Student Journey & Assessment Calendar

Onboarding → learning → practice → projects → assessment → mentorship → capstone → career readiness → graduation → 30/60/90-day alumni follow-up.

That would make AAN's system considerably more professional than simply publishing a timetable of classes.

And importantly, we can retain your hard rule: **Sunday is completely free for everyone.**